

Well-being salience in corporate disclosures and employee health

Riccardo Di Francesco¹ **Seetha Menon¹**

¹University of Southern Denmark

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*I am on the job market in
2026–27.*

Introduction

Firms and workplaces are central to people's lives.

- ⇒ Most adults spend a large share of their waking hours at work.
- ⇒ Where people work matters for wages, career trajectories, and health.

Yet workplace's **aspects that are likely most salient** for workers are precisely those that are **hardest to observe**.

A key challenge is that even administrative data provide only a partial view.

- ⇒ Typically record employment, earnings, hours, occupations, and industries.
- ⇒ No direct measurement of firms' priorities and internal practices.
- ⇒ Survey-based measures are informative but costly and difficult to scale.

This paper

We **leverage text to measure latent aspects** of the workplace.

- ⇒ Measure how prominently specific themes are discussed.
- ⇒ Transform unstructured corporate text into scalable firm-level indicators.
- ⇒ Focus on the salience of employee well-being in disclosures.

We construct our measure from Danish firms' annual reports.

- ⇒ Financial statements submitted to the Danish Business Authority.
- ⇒ Principal means by which firms communicate to external stakeholders.
- ⇒ Can also discuss non-financial priorities.

Why Denmark?

1. Universal and free health-care coverage.
 - ⇒ Cross-firm differences in employees' health reflect different environments.
2. Population-wide matched employer–employee administrative data.
 - ⇒ Test whether firm language predicts employee mental health and well-being.

A new *well-being salience score*

Using deep learning (Reimers and Gurevych, 2019), we construct a firm-level ***well-being salience score*** from corporate disclosures.

1. Not sector boilerplate.
2. Captures an additional latent dimension of firms.
3. Predicts every health outcome we measure.

Specifically, ↑ salience is associated with ↑ utilization of mental-health care and sickness absence.

1. Higher-salience firms may have stronger incentives to discuss well-being, and/or
2. they foster workplace cultures that reduce the stigma of seeking treatment.

⇒ Both channels suggest that something about firms shapes health.

Cross-sectional regressions cannot test this premise.

- ⇒ High-salience firms may simply employ workers who are less healthy.
- ⇒ Compositional sorting may confound any workplace channel.

Mover analysis

We adopt a **mover design** to separate worker-specific from firm-specific contributions to health outcomes (Finkelstein et al., 2016; Badinski et al., 2023; Ahammer et al., 2024).

- ⇒ Event study around firm changes, indexed by the *salience differential*.
- ⇒ Identification: no selection into destinations based on health shocks.
- ⇒ E.g., no sicker workers systematically choosing higher-salience firms.

Workers moving to higher-salience firms show

1. a sharp, persistent increase in sickness absence, but
 2. no detectable change in clinical health utilization.
- ⇒ Suggests a behavioral channel rather than acute health deterioration.

We document that the result is

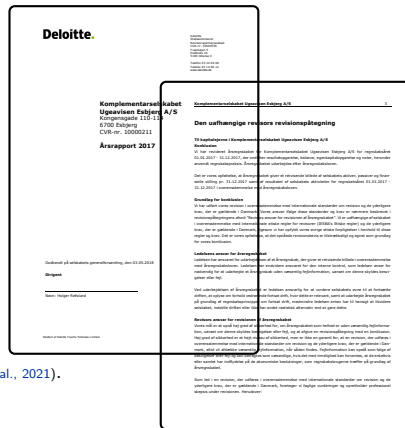
- present across several worker subgroups,
- robust to alternative sample constructions, and
- absent when the salience differential is randomly reassigned across workers.

Annual reports

Danish firms must submit annual reports to the Business Authority.

⇒ Required content varies by legal form.

⇒ Can discuss non-financial priorities.



We obtain all reports for 2013–2022.

⇒ Danish Business Authority's API.

⇒ English translation using *M2M-100* (Fan et al., 2021).

Administrative data

We construct several individual-level **proxies for (mental) health**.

1. Mental-health pharmaceutical uptake.
2. Hospitalizations for mental/behavioural disorders.
3. Visits to psychiatrists and/or psychologists.
4. Absence days from work due to illness.

We complement our outcomes with employment conditions, workplace characteristics, and sociodemographics.

- ⇒ Employer–employee panel covering the employed population.
- ⇒ Restrict to individuals in full-time employment and retain only their primary job.

We construct our analytical sample by aggregating the **matched employer–employee data to the firm level**.

- ⇒ Summarize employee health outcomes at intensive/extensive margin.
- ⇒ Construct relevant firms' characteristics.
- ⇒ Restrict to firms with at least ten-employees and a non-missing annual report.

Our *embedding* approach—Key ingredients

To define our semantic target, we draw from a set of **word lists from LIWC**

(Tausczik and Pennebaker, 2010; Boyd et al., 2022).

- ⇒ Thematically grouped sets of words developed by linguistic psychologists.
- ⇒ Widely used in econ/political science (see, e.g., Kosmidis et al., 2019; Gennaro and Ash, 2022).

We select two specific lists.

Mental Health (e.g., *coping*, *depression*, *mental health*).

Wellness (e.g., *mindfulness*, *healthful*, *well-being*).

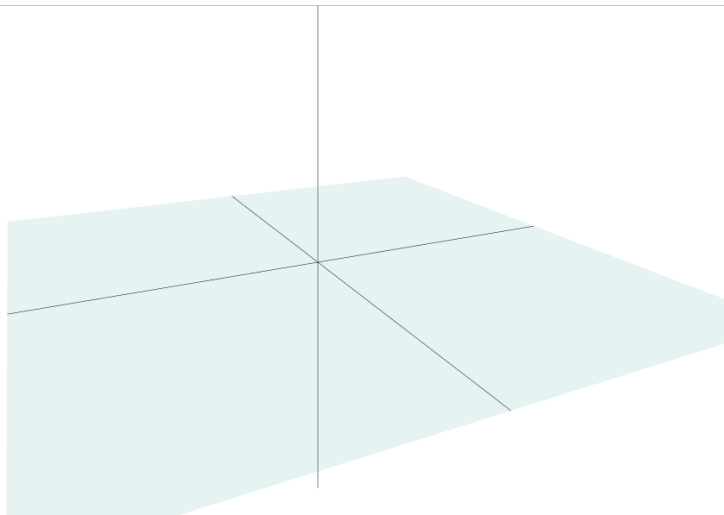
- ⇒ Manual validation step (RA).
- ⇒ Final dictionary of 293 terms.

We rely on a **pretrained Sentence–BERT** model (Reimers and Gurevych, 2019).

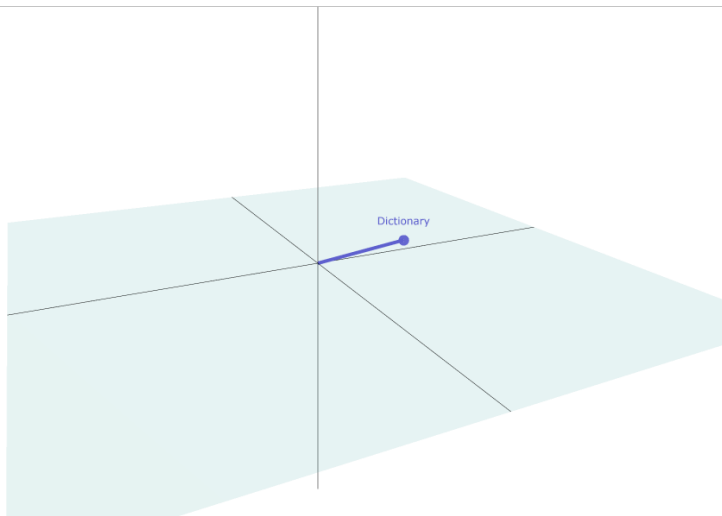
- ⇒ Sentence embeddings encode compositional semantics (e.g., polysemy).
- ⇒ Allows to evaluate reports *locally*.

▶▶ LIWC entries.

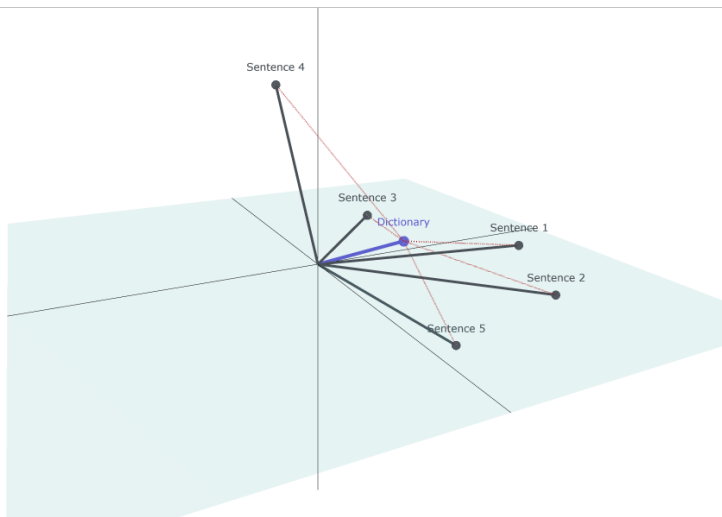
Our *embedding* approach—Overview



Our *embedding* approach—Overview



Our *embedding* approach—Overview



Our *embedding* approach—Empirical trade-offs

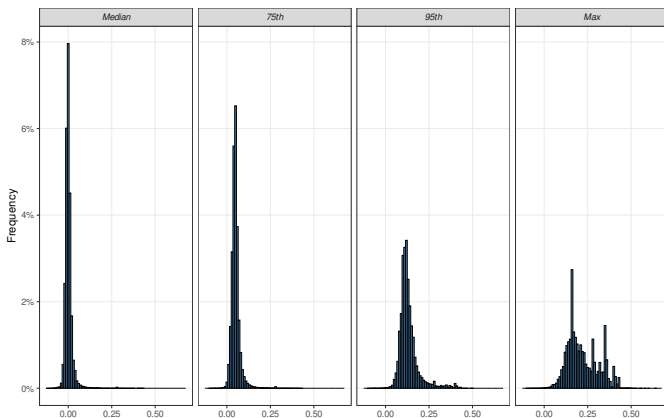


Figure 1: Distribution of alternative report-level salience scores. For each report, we compare every sentence embedding to the salience dictionary vector and summarize the resulting similarity distributions with alternative percentiles.

Variation in well-being salience

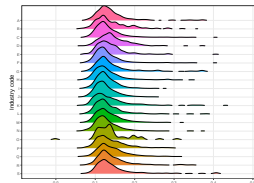


Table 1: Explained variation in the salience score.

	Salience score			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Adjusted R^2	0.015	0.001	0.006	0.652
Industry FEs	✓			
Occupational HHI		✓		
Year FEs			✓	
Firm FEs				✓
Observations	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072

Notes. Column (1) regresses the salience score on industry fixed effects only. Column (2) regresses the salience score on the occupational Herfindahl–Hirschman Index (HHI) only. Columns (3) and (4) regress the salience score on year fixed effects and firm fixed effects, respectively. The table reports adjusted R^2 to summarize the share of variation accounted for by each specification.

► Document length.

Well-being salience and observable characteristics

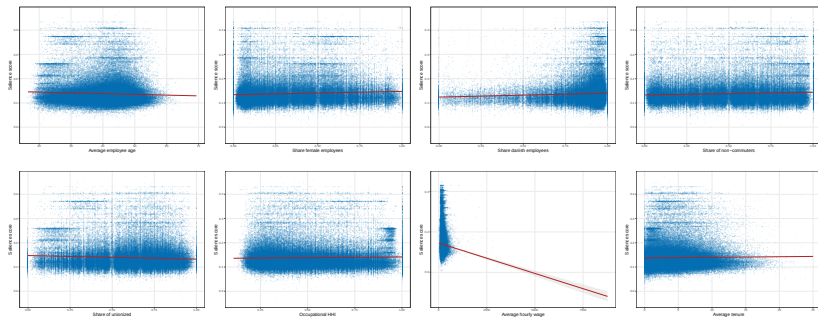


Figure 2: Well-being salience and standard firm-level characteristics. Each panel plots the firm-level salience score against a single covariate (mean employee age, share of female employees, share of Danish employees, share of non-commuters, share of union members, occupational HHI, mean hourly wage, and mean tenure), together with a linear fit.

Well-being salience and employee health

Prescription drug outcomes

Table 2: Salience and employee health: prescription drug outcomes.

	Avg. drug exp. (1)	Avg. drug cons. (2)	Avg. # prescriptions (3)	Share drug users (4)	Any drug user (5)
Salience	25.76*** (8.60)	6.50*** (1.91)	0.12*** (0.03)	0.01** (0.00)	0.39*** (0.03)
Outcome mean	39.72	18.04	0.30	0.07	0.77
Observations	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072
Industry FEs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FEs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Firm controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes. Each column reports estimates from a separate OLS regression of the indicated firm-level outcome on the salience score and a common set of firm-level controls (organizational structure, workforce composition, and employment conditions), including industry and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the firm level are reported in parentheses. Significance levels: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

▶▶ Hospitalizations/Psychiatrists.

▶▶ Absenteeism.

▶▶ Gender heterogeneity.

▶▶ Alternative scores.

▶▶ Doc length.

Empirical Strategy

For each mover i , we define the *salience differential*

$$\delta_i := \bar{s}_{d(i)} - \bar{s}_{o(i)}. \quad (1)$$

We then estimate the event-study specification

$$y_{it} = \alpha_i + \sum_{r \neq -1} \theta_r \mathbf{1}(r_{it} = r) \delta_i + \tau_t + x'_{it} \beta + \varepsilon_{it}. \quad (2)$$

⇒ The coefficients of interest are $\{\theta_r\}_{r \neq -1}$.

Causal interpretation requires that the move is uncorrelated with

1. Contemporaneous health shocks that trigger the move and correlate with δ_i .
2. Differential pre-trends in y_{it} across movers with different δ_i .
3. Anticipation effects that adjust behavior before the move.

Salience differential distribution

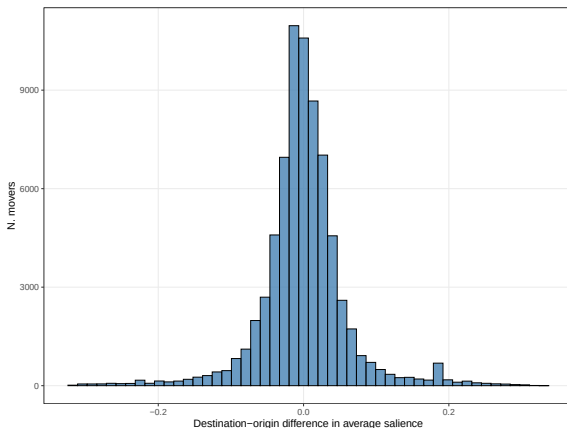


Figure 3: Distribution of the salience differential δ_i , defined as the destination-origin difference in average well-being salience.

► Movers vs. all (outcomes).

► Movers vs. all (covariates).

► Up/down (outcomes).

► Up/down (covariates).

Event-study results—Absence outcomes

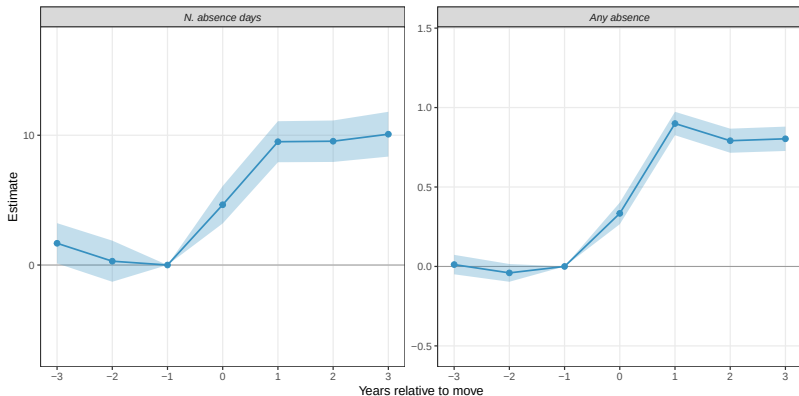


Figure 4: Event-study coefficients θ_r for absence days (left) and probability of any absence (right). Coefficients are estimated per unit of δ_i ; $r = -1$ normalized to zero. Shaded bands report 95% confidence intervals from standard errors clustered at the worker level.

Main takeaways

We develop a scalable, text-based measure of salience of employee well-being in corporate disclosures.

- ⇒ Not driven by sector boilerplate language.
- ⇒ Captures an additional latent dimension of firms.
- ⇒ Predicts utilization of mental-health care and sickness absence.

Workers moving to higher-salience firms show a sharp, persistent increase in sickness absence.

- ⇒ Firms shape worker absence behavior.

Absence response without medical response suggests a behavioral channel (norms, stigma) rather than acute health deterioration.

Appendix—Annual reports

Descriptives

Table 3: Corpus size, document length, and lexical diversity.

Panel A. Corpus size				
N. documents				2,557,796
Total words				4,021,515,009
Total sentences				150,017,499
Panel B. Document length and lexical diversity				
	<i>Words</i>	<i>Sentences</i>	<i>Unique words</i>	<i>TTR</i>
Mean	1,572	59	503	0.365
SD	952	34	221	0.105
Min	2	1	1	0.005
P10	596	24	257	0.288
P25	1,051	41	391	0.312
P50	1,463	56	496	0.341
P75	1,972	72	613	0.378
P90	2,539	91	739	0.444
Max	78,697	2,592	9,327	1.000

Notes. Statistics computed on the translated corpus. Panel A displays statistics aggregated across all firms' reports. Panel B displays report-level statistics. TTR is the share of unique tokens (here words) in a document; lower values indicate more repetition. Values are rounded to the nearest integer, except TTR (three decimals).

Appendix—Annual reports

Most frequent words

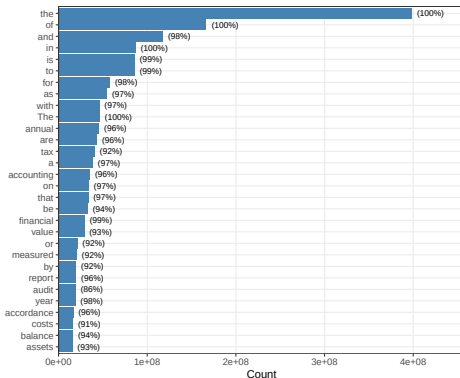


Figure 5: Most frequent words in the analysis corpus (top 30), ordered by word count. Bars show total token counts; the parenthetical labels report the share of reports containing each word.

Appendix—Analytical sample

Balance table

Table 4: Descriptive statistics for firms with and without a linked salience score.

	Not linked	Linked	N. diff.	Log SD
<i>Sample size</i>				
N. employees	11,162,975	9,816,026	–	–
N. firms	21,695	31,321	–	–
N. industries	21	21	–	–
<i>Organizational structure</i>				
Share large firms	0.50 (0.50)	0.49 (0.50)	-0.017	0.000
Share multi-establishment firms	0.22 (0.42)	0.21 (0.41)	-0.037	-0.026
<i>Workforce composition and employment conditions</i>				
Avg. employee age	41.45 (8.19)	39.85 (7.83)	-0.199	-0.045
Share female employees	0.55 (0.26)	0.33 (0.26)	-0.822	-0.029
Share Danish employees	0.90 (0.15)	0.89 (0.16)	-0.084	0.059
Occupational HHI	0.50 (0.20)	0.51 (0.22)	0.067	0.097
Avg. hourly wage (DKK)	211.04 (74.16)	222.22 (81.28)	0.144	0.092
Avg. tenure (years)	4.39 (3.01)	4.46 (3.32)	0.022	0.096
Share local employees	0.56 (0.27)	0.50 (0.28)	-0.196	0.052
Share union members	0.65 (0.22)	0.60 (0.21)	-0.244	-0.051

Notes. Means are reported with standard deviations in parentheses. “Linked” indicates firms for which a salience score can be assigned from an observed annual report. Large firms are defined as those with an above-median employee count. “N. diff.” denotes the normalized difference in means; “Log SD” reports the logarithm of the ratio of standard deviations. “N. employees” reports the cumulative firm-level employee count summed across all firm-years in the 2013–2022 panel.

Appendix—LIWC entries

Table 5: LIWC Mental Health and Wellness entries.

Panel A. Unigrams (N = 156)

acupunct*, addict, addicted, addicting, addiction, addictive, adhd, aerobics, agoraphobi*, alcoholics, alcoholism, anhedon*, anorexi*, antidepressant*, antioxidant*, antipsychotic, antisocial, aromatherapy, asperger*, aspie, aspies, atkins, autism, autistic, ayurveda, ayurvedic, biofeedback, bipolar, bpd, bulimi*, calisthenics, cardio, cbt, chakra, chiropract*, compulsive, cope, coped, copes, coping, crossfit, delusion*, depressed, depression, depressive, detox*, diet, dietary, dietetic*, dietician*, dieting, dietitian*, diets, dsm, dysmorphi*, fitbit*, fitness*, gym*, hallucinat*, heal, healed, healer*, healing, healthful, healthily, healthy, histrionic, homeopath*, hydrat*, hydrotherapy, hypochondria*, insanit*, insomnia*, internaliz*, invigor*, jogger*, jogging, keto, ketogen*, kleptomania*, malinger*, mania, manic, masseur, masseuse, meditat*, mindfulness, multivitamin*, munchausen, nami, neurodiver*, neuroses, neurosis, neurotic, neuroticism, neurotypical, nutrient, nutrients, nutrition*, nutritionist, nutritious, obsessive, ocd, organic*, osteopath*, paranoi*, paranoid, phobi*, pilates, prozac, psychiatric, psychiatrist, psychiatry, psychoanalysis, psychoanalyst, psychologist, psychopath, psychopathology, psychopathy, psychosis, psychosomatic, psychotherapist, psychotherapy, psychotic, ptsd, pyromania, pyromaniac, rejuvenat*, ritalin, sane, sanity, sauna, schizo, schizo*, scizophrenia, sertraline, sociopath*, spa, spas, spiritual*, ssri, suicid*, supported, thorazine, trauma*, trichotilloman*, tw, vitality, vitamin*, wellbeing, wellness, workahol*, xanax, yoga, zen, zolof

Panel B. Bigrams (N = 81)

alternative medicine*, anti aging, anti depressant*, anti-aging, anti-depressant*, anxiety disorder, balanced diet, behav* therapy, binge eat*, binge-eat*, borderline personality, breathing exercise*, chinese medicine, clinical depression, coconut water, conduct disorder, crisis intervention*, day spa*, disease prevention, eating disorder*, essential oil*, expressive writing, fish oil, gluten free, gluten-free, gmo free, gmo-free, herbal medicine*, herbal tea*, life coach, lift* weights, major depression, mental health, mental illness*, mental institution*, mentally ill, nervous breakdown, nervous disorder, non gmo, non-gmo, omega 3, panic attack*, panic disorder*, personality disorder*, physical activity, physical fitness, physical therapy, positive mood, post traumatic, post-traumatic, postpartum depression, preventative care, preventative medicine, quit* smoking, self care, self compassion, self harm, self help, self improvement, self-care, self-compassion, self-harm, self-help, self-improvement, strength train*, substance abuse, support group*, sweat lodge*, t'ai chi, tai chi, tai-chi, talk therapy, talk-therapy, weight gain, weight lifting, weight loss, well balanced, well being, well-balanced, well-being, whole grain

Panel C. 3+ word phrases (N = 6)

attention deficit disorder, attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, meaning in life, on the wagon, seasonal affective disorder, substance use disorder

Notes. Entries are taken from the LIWC Mental Health and Wellness lists and shown as written in the source. Terms are alphabetically ordered within each panel.

Appendix—Variation in well-being salience

Document length

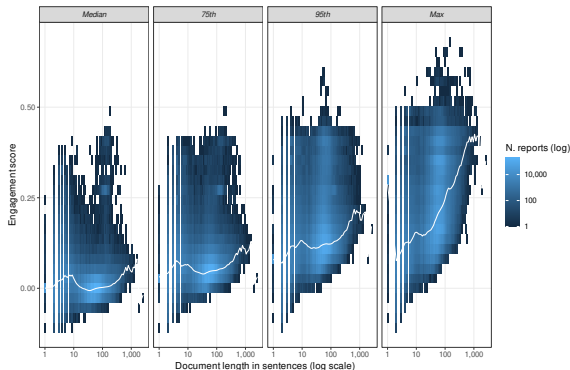


Figure 6: Salience scores against document length (measured in sentences). Columns use alternative within-report summaries of the sentence-dictionary similarity distribution. To mitigate overplotting, we show a binned heatmap: the length–score plane is partitioned into rectangular bins, and shading reflects the number of reports in each bin. The white curve traces the median score within each length bin.

Appendix—Well-being salience and employee health

Hospitalizations and specialists

Table 6: Salience and employee health: hospitalizations and psychologist/psychiatrist visits.

	Hospitalizations			Psych. visits		
	Avg. days (1)	Share (2)	Any (3)	Avg. visits (4)	Share (5)	Any (6)
Salience	0.001* (0.001)	0.001** (0.000)	0.060*** (0.011)	-0.024* (0.014)	-0.005*** (0.002)	0.527*** (0.042)
Outcome mean	0.001	0.001	0.018	0.109	0.018	0.389
Observations	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072
Industry FEs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FEs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Firm controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes. Each column reports estimates from a separate OLS regression of the indicated firm-level outcome on the salience score and a common set of firm-level controls (organizational structure, workforce composition, and employment conditions), including industry and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the firm level are reported in parentheses. Hospitalization days refer to the number of days hospitalized for mental-health reasons. Significance levels: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Appendix—Well-being salience and employee health

Absenteeism outcomes

Table 7: Salience and employee health: absenteeism outcomes.

	Avg. absence days (1)	Share absents (2)	Any absence (3)
Salience	2.22*** (0.19)	0.23*** (0.02)	0.39*** (0.04)
Outcome mean	0.64	0.07	0.43
Observations	172,072	172,072	172,072
Industry FEs	✓	✓	✓
Year FEs	✓	✓	✓
Firm controls	✓	✓	✓

Notes. Each column reports estimates from a separate OLS regression of the indicated firm-level outcome on the salience score and a common set of firm-level controls (organizational structure, workforce composition, and employment conditions), including industry and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the firm level are reported in parentheses. Absence days measure days absent due to own illness or a child's illness. Significance levels: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Appendix—Well-being salience and employee health

Table 8: Salience and employee health, by gender composition of firms.

	Male-dominated	Female-dominated
<i>Panel A: Prescription drug outcomes</i>		
Avg. drug exp.	10.75 (9.446)	56.86*** (16.03)
Avg. drug cons.	5.091** (2.070)	9.706*** (3.655)
Avg. # prescriptions	0.0880** (0.0375)	0.2064*** (0.0655)
Share drug users	0.0108** (0.0052)	0.0100 (0.0083)
Any drug user	0.3913*** (0.0390)	0.3627*** (0.0451)
<i>Panel B: Hospitalizations and psychologist/psychiatrist visits</i>		
Avg. hosp. days	0.0011 (0.0009)	0.0015* (0.0009)
Share hospitalized	0.0008** (0.0004)	0.0007 (0.0004)
Any hospitalization	0.0574*** (0.0135)	0.0546*** (0.0156)
Avg. psych visits	0.0062 (0.0167)	-0.0691** (0.0272)
Share psych users	-0.0001 (0.0020)	-0.0132*** (0.0036)
Any psych visit	0.6052*** (0.0518)	0.3286*** (0.0613)
<i>Panel C: Absenteeism outcomes</i>		
Avg. absence days	2.440*** (0.2476)	1.611*** (0.2270)
Share absents	0.2521*** (0.0248)	0.1592*** (0.0218)
Any absence	0.4993*** (0.0492)	0.1354** (0.0557)
Observations	124,806	47,266
Industry FEs	✓	✓
Year FEs	✓	✓
Firm controls	✓	✓

Notes. Each cell reports the coefficient on the salience score from a separate OLS regression of the indicated firm-level outcome on the salience score and a common set of firm-level controls, including industry and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the firm level are reported in parentheses. Significance levels: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Appendix—Well-being salience and employee health

Table 9: Alternative salience score definitions and employee health.

	Median	75th	95th	Max
<i>Panel A: Prescription drug outcomes</i>				
Avg. drug exp.	97.92*** (25.31)	45.59** (17.96)	25.76*** (8.596)	9.155* (5.380)
Avg. drug cons.	13.05** (5.401)	9.581** (4.236)	6.499*** (1.911)	1.061 (1.030)
Avg. # prescriptions	0.286*** (0.0919)	0.167** (0.0717)	0.123*** (0.0348)	0.0278 (0.0187)
Share drug users	0.0157 (0.0136)	0.0113 (0.0099)	0.0088** (0.0045)	-0.0000 (0.0025)
Any drug user	1.356*** (0.110)	0.992*** (0.0767)	0.389*** (0.0309)	0.235*** (0.0171)
<i>Panel B: Hospitalizations and psychologist/psychiatrist visits</i>				
Avg. hosp. days	0.0024 (0.0017)	0.0019 (0.0014)	0.0013* (0.0007)	0.0003 (0.0004)
Share hospitalized	0.0014** (0.0007)	0.0015** (0.0007)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0001)
Any hospitalization	0.250*** (0.0510)	0.191*** (0.0377)	0.0603*** (0.0113)	0.0271*** (0.0059)
Avg. psych visits	-0.0204 (0.0435)	-0.0045 (0.0366)	-0.0238* (0.0144)	-0.0023 (0.0078)
Share psych users	-0.0057 (0.0058)	-0.0019 (0.0044)	-0.0053*** (0.0018)	-0.0014 (0.0010)
Any psych visit	2.694*** (0.182)	1.960*** (0.130)	0.527*** (0.0418)	0.340*** (0.0227)
<i>Panel C: Absenteeism outcomes</i>				
Avg. absence days	12.30*** (0.981)	8.837*** (0.683)	2.221*** (0.189)	1.330*** (0.106)
Share absents	1.283*** (0.0967)	0.898*** (0.0674)	0.227*** (0.0189)	0.134*** (0.0103)
Any absence	2.100*** (0.173)	1.526*** (0.122)	0.389*** (0.0396)	0.286*** (0.0216)
Observations	172,072	172,072	172,072	172,072
Industry FEs	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FEs	✓	✓	✓	✓
Firm controls	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes. Each cell reports the coefficient on the salience score from a separate OLS regression of the indicated firm-level outcome on the salience score and a common set of firm-level controls, including industry and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the firm level are reported in parentheses. Significance levels: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Appendix—Well-being salience and employee health

Table 10: Report length and employee health.

	Report length
<i>Panel A: Prescription drug outcomes</i>	
Avg. drug exp.	-0.0192*** (0.0074)
Avg. drug cons.	-0.0083*** (0.0018)
Avg. # prescriptions	-0.0001*** (0.0000)
Share drug users	-0.0000*** (0.0000)
Any drug user	0.0008*** (0.0000)
<i>Panel B: Hospitalizations and psychologist/psychiatrist visits</i>	
Avg. hosp. days	-0.0000 (0.0000)
Share hospitalized	-0.0000 (0.0000)
Any hospitalization	0.0001*** (0.0000)
Avg. psych visits	-0.0001*** (0.0000)
Share psych users	-0.0000*** (0.0000)
Any psych visit	0.0015*** (0.0001)
<i>Panel C: Absenteeism outcomes</i>	
Avg. absence days	0.0061*** (0.0004)
Share absents	0.0006*** (0.0000)
Any absence	0.0015*** (0.0001)
Observations	172,072
Industry FEs	✓
Year FEs	✓
Firm controls	✓

Notes. Each cell reports the coefficient on report length (the number of sentences in the firm's annual report) from a separate OLS regression of the indicated firm-level outcome on report length and a common set of firm-level controls, including industry and year fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at the firm level are reported in parentheses. Significance levels: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Appendix—Balance (movers vs all)

Outcomes

Table 11: Descriptive statistics for the full panel and the mover sample.

	Full panel	Movers	N. diff.	Log SD
<i>Sample size</i>				
N. worker-years	23,299,210	302,720	–	–
N. unique workers	3,579,085	71,714	–	–
<i>Health outcomes</i>				
Avg. drug exp.	51.09 (651.91)	33.40 (406.14)	-0.033	-0.473
Avg. drug cons.	23.08 (119.54)	12.98 (85.49)	-0.097	-0.335
Avg. # prescriptions	0.39 (1.96)	0.24 (1.44)	-0.088	-0.308
Any drug user	0.09 (0.29)	0.06 (0.24)	-0.110	-0.177
Avg. hosp. days	0.001 (0.08)	0.001 (0.07)	-0.001	-0.133
Any hospitalization	0.0004 (0.02)	0.0004 (0.02)	0.001	0.028
Avg. psych visits	0.15 (1.24)	0.08 (0.87)	-0.063	-0.353
Any psych visit	0.02 (0.15)	0.01 (0.12)	-0.072	-0.256
Absence days	4.60 (14.27)	2.41 (9.08)	-0.183	-0.452
Any absence	0.39 (0.49)	0.28 (0.45)	-0.238	-0.086

Notes. The full panel includes all worker-years in the matched employer-employee data set; movers are workers with at least one firm change satisfying the balanced-sample restriction. For the mover sample, statistics are computed over the pre-move period ($r < 0$). Means are reported with standard deviations in parentheses. "N. diff." denotes the normalized difference in means; "Log SD" reports the logarithm of the ratio of standard deviations.

Appendix—Balance (movers vs all)

Characteristics

Table 12: Descriptive statistics for the full panel and the mover sample.

	Full panel	Movers	N. diff.	Log SD
<i>Sample size</i>				
N. worker-years	23,299,210	302,720	–	–
N. unique workers	3,579,085	71,714	–	–
<i>Employment conditions</i>				
Hourly wage (DKK)	223.70 (176.62)	243.27 (161.57)	0.116	-0.089
Tenure (years)	4.31 (6.14)	5.81 (5.91)	0.250	-0.040
Same residence	0.51 (0.50)	0.44 (0.50)	-0.157	-0.008
Union member	0.69 (0.46)	0.70 (0.46)	0.028	-0.012
<i>Sociodemographics</i>				
Age	41.28 (13.95)	41.44 (11.03)	0.013	-0.235
Female	0.49 (0.50)	0.29 (0.46)	-0.411	-0.094
Danish	0.89 (0.31)	0.92 (0.27)	0.102	-0.142

Notes. The full panel includes all worker-years in the matched employer-employee data set; movers are workers with at least one firm change satisfying the balanced-sample restriction. For the mover sample, statistics are computed over the pre-move period ($r < 0$). Means are reported with standard deviations in parentheses. "N. diff." denotes the normalized difference in means; "Log SD" reports the logarithm of the ratio of standard deviations.

Appendix—Balance (up- vs. down-movers)

Outcomes

Table 13: Descriptive statistics for down- and up-movers.

	Down-movers ($\delta_i < 0$)	Up-movers ($\delta_i > 0$)	N. diff.	Log SD
<i>Sample size</i>				
N. worker-years	159,279	143,441	—	—
N. unique workers	37,370	34,344	—	—
<i>Health outcomes</i>				
Avg. drug exp.	34.35 (421.32)	32.34 (388.58)	-0.005	-0.081
Avg. drug cons.	12.92 (85.00)	13.04 (86.03)	0.001	0.012
Avg. # prescriptions	0.24 (1.37)	0.24 (1.51)	0.001	0.097
Any drug user	0.06 (0.24)	0.06 (0.24)	-0.004	-0.007
Avg. hosp. days	0.001 (0.09)	0.001 (0.04)	-0.004	-0.835
Any hospitalization	0.0004 (0.02)	0.0004 (0.02)	-0.002	-0.040
Avg. psych visits	0.08 (0.90)	0.08 (0.84)	-0.004	-0.070
Any psych visit	0.01 (0.12)	0.01 (0.12)	0.000	0.002
Absence days	2.79 (9.92)	2.00 (8.02)	-0.087	-0.212
Any absence	0.31 (0.46)	0.24 (0.43)	-0.161	-0.082

Notes. The sample is the balanced mover panel. Down-movers are workers with $\delta_i < 0$ (move to a lower-salience firm); up-movers are workers with $\delta_i > 0$. Means are reported with standard deviations in parentheses. "N. diff." denotes the normalized difference in means; "Log SD" reports the logarithm of the ratio of standard deviations. All statistics are computed over the pre-move period ($r < 0$).

Appendix—Balance (up- vs. down-movers)

Characteristics

Table 14: Descriptive statistics for down- and up-movers.

	Down-movers ($\delta_i < 0$)	Up-movers ($\delta_i > 0$)	N. diff.	Log SD
<i>Sample size</i>				
N. worker-years	159,279	143,441	—	—
N. unique workers	37,370	34,344	—	—
<i>Employment conditions</i>				
Hourly wage (DKK)	245.24 (171.65)	241.08 (149.55)	-0.026	-0.138
Tenure (years)	5.89 (5.95)	5.72 (5.86)	-0.029	-0.015
Same residence	0.44 (0.50)	0.44 (0.50)	-0.003	0.000
Union member	0.71 (0.46)	0.70 (0.46)	-0.011	0.005
<i>Sociodemographics</i>				
Age	41.61 (11.03)	41.25 (11.02)	-0.033	-0.001
Female	0.29 (0.45)	0.29 (0.46)	0.002	0.001
Danish	0.92 (0.27)	0.92 (0.28)	-0.022	0.034

Notes. The sample is the balanced mover panel. Down-movers are workers with $\delta_i < 0$ (move to a lower-salience firm); up-movers are workers with $\delta_i > 0$. Means are reported with standard deviations in parentheses. "N. diff." denotes the normalized difference in means; "Log SD" reports the logarithm of the ratio of standard deviations. All statistics are computed over the pre-move period ($r < 0$).

Event-study results—Other outcomes

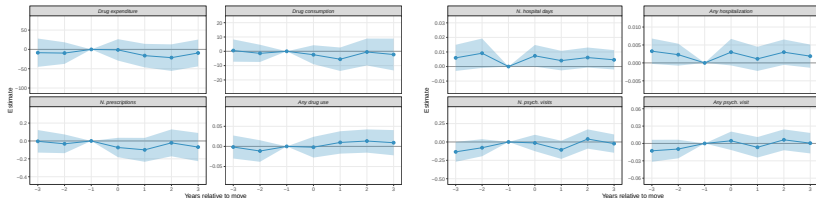


Figure 7: Event-study coefficients θ_r for prescription drug uptake (left) and hospitalization and specialist-visit outcomes (right). Coefficients are estimated per unit of δ_i , with $r = -1$ normalized to zero. Shaded bands report 95% confidence intervals constructed from standard errors clustered at the worker level.

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Event-study results—Heterogeneity

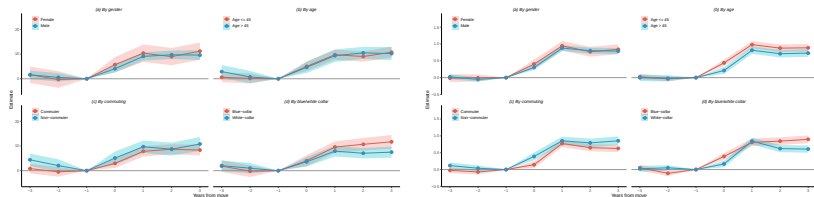


Figure 8: Heterogeneity in the event-study response of absence outcomes. Each figure reports event-study coefficients θ_r estimated separately on subsamples defined by (a) gender, (b) age above or below 45, (c) commuting status, and (d) occupation (blue- versus white-collar). Coefficients are estimated per unit of δ_i , with $r = -1$ normalized to zero. Shaded bands report 95% confidence intervals constructed from standard errors clustered at the worker level.

Event-study results—Robustness to tenure window

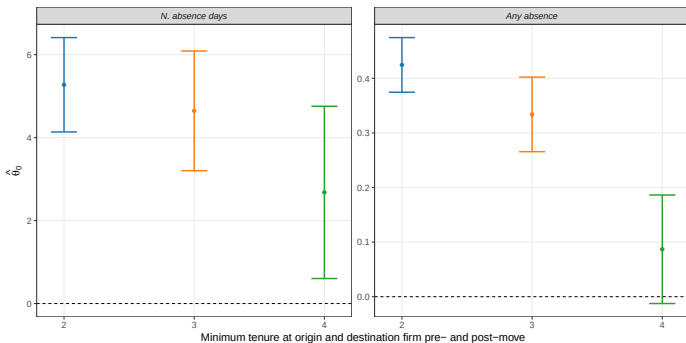


Figure 9: On-impact event-study coefficient $\hat{\theta}_0$ for absence days (left) and the probability of any absence (right), estimated on alternative balanced-mover samples defined by the minimum tenure required at both the origin and destination firm. The horizontal axis varies the minimum tenure from two to four years on each side of the move. Vertical bars report 95% confidence intervals constructed from standard errors clustered at the worker level.

Event-study results—Placebo

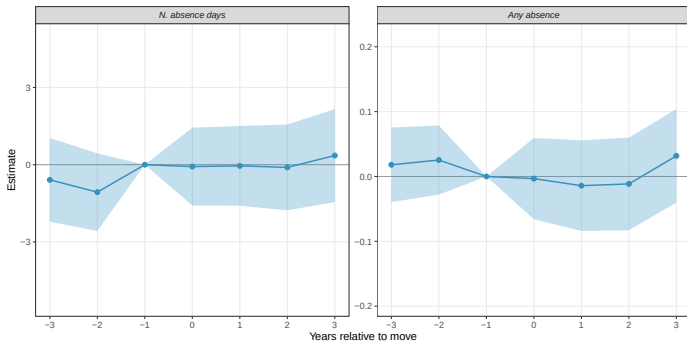


Figure 10: Placebo event-study coefficients θ_r for absence days (left) and the probability of any absence (right). The salience differential δ_i is randomly permuted across workers, breaking the link between each worker and the actual destination–origin gap while preserving the marginal distribution of δ_i . Coefficients are estimated per unit of the permuted δ_i , with $r = -1$ normalized to zero. Shaded bands report 95% confidence intervals constructed from standard errors clustered at the worker level.